

competent enough (in nuclear sector) in India.

We want to have more NPCILs to be created in the country to expedite the nuclear power deployment.

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**Investments required to meet the 100-GW nuclear target will be huge. Are the sources of funding being looked at?**

SMR designs are in progress worldwide. Except a few, most of them are under development phase. NPCIL is also working on this concept. So, people are working independently and as of now NPCIL has its own programme.

However, many technology developers are in talks with us. So, I think it will take some time.

implementing six units of 1,000-MW capacity each with collaboration from the Russian Federation. Of these, two units are already operational, while four are under various stages of construction.

We also envision setting up more nuclear power reactors with foreign cooperation.

those challenges, but could also demonstrate our capability.

We have the oldest operational nuclear power plants in the world, one of our units has continuously operated for 962 days, a world record of its time, and 52 times our reactors operated continuously for more than a year and still counting.

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**NPCIL is going for nuclear reactors on a fleet mode. What are the key things you are looking at?**

For fleet mode, ideally in my opinion, coastal sites are preferred as they have abundance of water.

We will also prefer if it is a barren land and rocky site.

With large land parcels available, instead of setting up two or four reactors, we can set up six or eight or even 10 reactors, subject to meeting the technical requirements.

The site configuration will also depend on what capacity reactors we are going to set up.

So, we should set up a pool of reactors at one place where land is stable from seismic point of view and there is water availability.

## THE AMOUNT OF CAPITAL INVOLVED IN UNDER CONSTRUCTION PROJECTS AND THOSE UNDER PRE-PROJECT ACTIVITIES WILL BE ₹2.7 LAKH CRORE.

As far as NPCIL is concerned, the amount of capital involved for the under-construction projects and those under pre-project activities will be to the tune of ₹2.7 lakh crore. Further, there will be significant investments towards additional reactors planned subsequently by NPCIL.

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**Any talks with US-based Holtec International for small modular reactors (SMRs) in India?**

As of now several

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**Is international collaboration being looked at for technology transfer/upgrade for future growth?**

As I already mentioned, our mainstay would be 700-MW indigenous pressurised heavy water reactors (PHWRs). However, for faster capacity addition to meet the energy demand and speed up decarbonisation efforts, large capacity light water reactors (LWRs) with foreign cooperation are also envisaged. We are already

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**What are the operational challenges and how are they being addressed?**

NPCIL has expertise and experience in operating reactors for decades and capabilities to address any kind of operational challenges ensuring highest levels of safety.

The journey of Indian Nuclear Power Programme is an ideal example of Atma Nirbhar Bharat.

Despite technology denial and embargo regimes, we not only successfully overcame

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